

THE CROSSROADS

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BEYOND THE GAME

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Secretary, 2023-24



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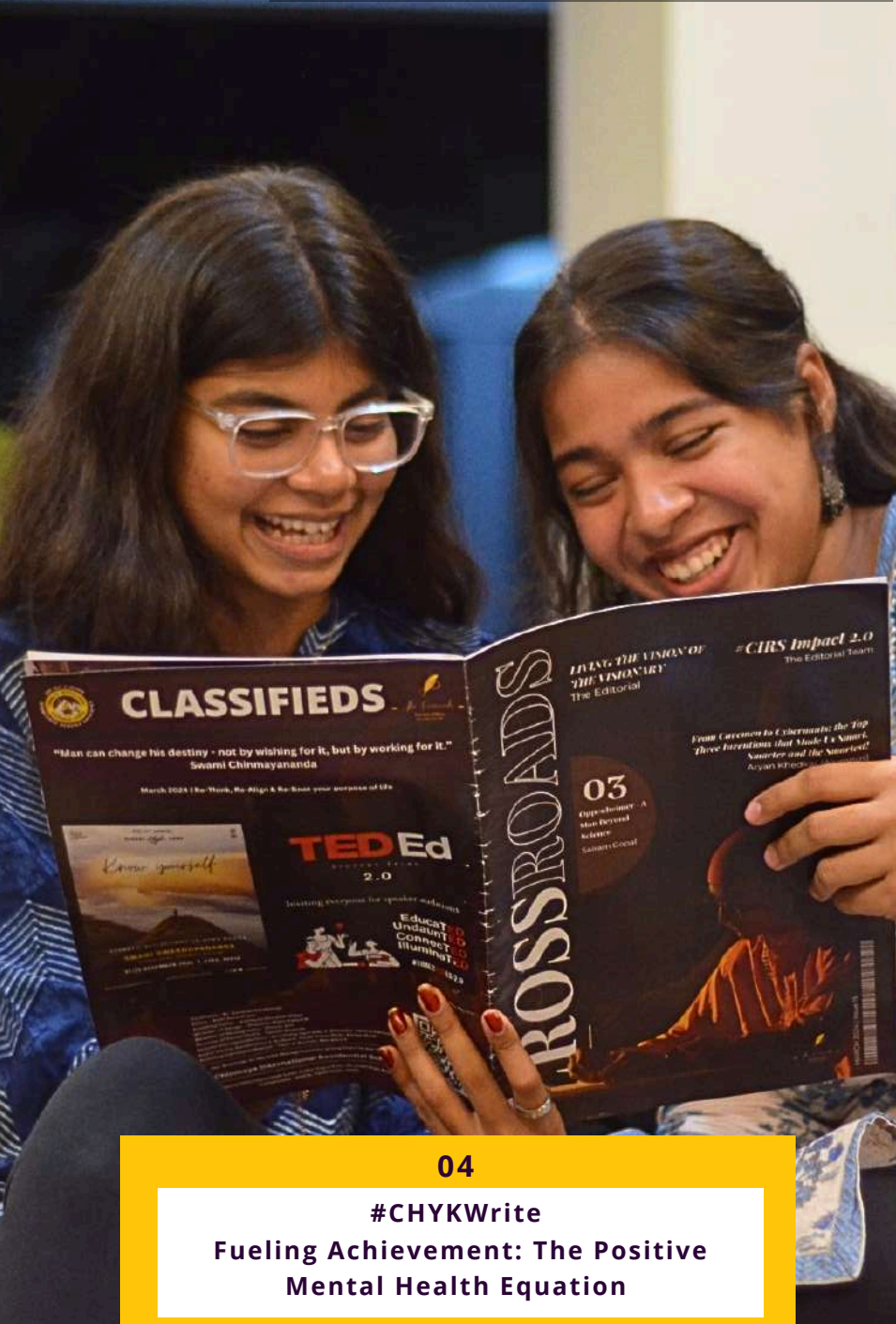
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Beyond the Game

Krish Modi - Sr. Sports Secretary, 2023-24

THE SOCIAL GLUE

The human brain evolved to navigate and maintain social structures of life. Primordially, we needed each other to survive. A tribe working together would survive, while a divided one died.

In 2022, 1 in 5 believed that political violence was justified. The world we live in has increasingly begun to see itself as members of opposing squads.

Of the many reasons we humans have brought up to account for our behavior, one is often blamed: social media. We blame it for making us more extremist and less empathetic, and emphasize the need to "touch grass" to escape into the real world. Sure, social media does have an effect on our brains, but maybe not the one you'd expect.

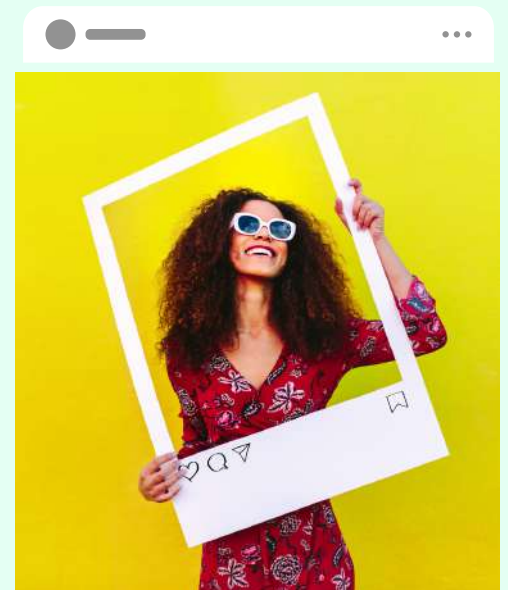
Introducing you to the myth of the 'filter bubble.' Many of us have heard about online filter bubbles, where algorithms only show us content that we want to see. Of course, what we want are opinions that agree with ours, thereby omitting opposing views. In this poisonous hole, our view of the world narrows and becomes radicalized. But is that true? An extreme filter bubble is very rare, and studies have found very little evidence for its existence. The internet is a dump of information, and we are constantly confronted with contrasting views.

The truth is that one is most ideologically isolated in one's own life. We choose the people we closely interact with, and not too surprisingly, the interactions with people around you are much less diverse than the so-called online bubbles.

The 'filter bubble' exists in our real lives, not online. Well then, what is the explanation behind humans turning against each other? Since social media constantly gives us diverse information, shouldn't it make us more open-minded and empathetic?

Unfortunately, our brains are flawed.

The human brain evolved to navigate and maintain social structures of life. Primordially, we needed each other to survive. A tribe working together would survive, while a divided one would die. That's why our brains had to make sure we cooperated. This propagates even today. Sure, you may dislike your neighbor, but since you live in the same area, you support the same cricket team and meet each other at the temple.



As societies grew, we started meeting at shopping malls and town squares. Being physically close made us familiar to each other, and bridged the gap between different worldviews. Ancestrally, the people around us were similar to us. We liked what was similar to us, and this kept us together despite our differences. Everything was going smoothly until 20 years ago, when we created something that hit our brains like a train: the brand-new digital town square - social media.



After this, our brains weren't able to handle the amount of disagreement they faced on social media, and we were not prepared for it. Our brains, in their attempt to simplify, sort everything into categories, whether you like it or not. People, things, and opinions all go into teams.

Researchers call this 'social sorting.' On the digital town square, we encounter many people with clashing opinions, but unlike your neighbor, they don't root for your cricket team. You miss the local social glue your brain needs to connect with them.



This contrast in belief suddenly becomes a central part of our identity. So, negative things about the "other team" are anchored upon and believed uncritically, whereas those who share your views are praised for their beliefs. People who think like you are added to your team. They are probably good people in your eyes, because any social group you belong to is good! Therefore, when you face negative information about your group, you dismiss it uncritically.

Social media, driven by engagement, makes it worse, as it wants to keep you online for as long as possible. Well, the most engaging emotion is, unfortunately, anger. The angrier you get, the more likely you are to comment, share, and engage. This leads social media to amplify the most extreme and controversial opinions. It doesn't just show disagreements; it shows the worst of them.



Our flawed brain is sorting people into teams, and so, the worst opinion is labeled, assigned, and generalized to everyone on that team (social community).

Something that is striking is that everything that makes us individuals – the ice cream flavor we prefer, the shows we watch, our religions, our fashion sense, and so on – are constantly belittled, as if they are part of mutually exclusive rival teams.

It seems as though the opposite team is almost willfully making the world a worse place, as though they are almost evil, beyond rationality and civil discussion.

While we are on the correct team (obviously it's our team), it may be hard for us to realize that we may seem that way to the people on the other team.

Essentially, we are dissolving the social glue that acts as a foundation for democracy.

If we think our own neighbors are evil, how can we live together? Is there something we can do? Something more positive? In the end, it is important to be aware of what social media does to your brain and know that it's easier to change yourself than to change the world.



Another journey at the Crossroads begins, and one draws to a close. As we flip through every article, every article and every design and every photograph over the past year, we can't help but admire the sheer effort and enthusiasm radiating from your work. Thank you for kindling the flame of literary brilliance this past year. It's a responsibility we now shoulder, and we hope to live up to the legacy of excellence you've left us.

In deep gratitude,
The Crossroads Editorial Team '25

One of the most ambitious projects CIRS students have undertaken is Vanguard. A mission to improve the mindsets and goals of the students, Vanguard works toward making leaders who will work toward solving modern-day problems from every approach with available resources.

In simple words, Vanguard is a leadership program. However, it was so much more to us, the candidates.

Discipline. Merit. Sacrifice.



We felt mostly triumphant when we were accepted into the program. If I'm being completely honest, we felt like we had beaten the other applicants by getting accepted. But we were soon to find out that Vanguard was not a destination to be reached, but the beginning of a journey towards something we didn't fully understand. Full of energy, we arrived at Day 0. One of the first things I heard one of our mentors say shattered my assumptions immediately: "Vanguard is not a privilege, but a responsibility." However, the fact that I got to learn concepts that I couldn't learn anywhere else was indeed a privilege.

Vanguard was an education, where our mentors taught us various concepts they believed to be cornerstones of leadership.

Vanguard involved learning things we had not thought of as more than abstract concepts that had to be understood instinctively,

such as critical thinking and communication. Vanguard proved us wrong. Vanguard, in a way, told me that I could be a lot more, if only I knew my shortcomings. Everything could be improved upon if I put in enough work, if I persevere long enough. The assignments we received were not about what we learnt; they were real-life applications.

They weren't hypothetical situations, but things we did everyday. They were hard. When we received our first assignments, we were mostly shocked. There were questions to be answered, just like the assignments we were used to. But these questions were not what we expected; these questions were about us. They were questions that made us reflect. 'Reflection' not in the sense of thinking about every word we'd spoken or action we'd done; it was reflection in the sense of, "Why am I doing what I'm doing, and why am I saying what I'm saying?"

There were questions we had never thought of before. At Vanguard, for the first time, we were told to ask questions. Far from being told to accept, we were encouraged to ask. That's how it all began. Activities, assignments, thinking. Each session different from the other.

Vanguard was established to create leaders, which it may or may not have, but we candidates have taken a leap - the first step and the hardest. We are far from being able to lead the world, but we have learnt how to control the decisions we make. We have learnt that the details in our every action - the ones we think are unimportant - are what matter the most.

After all, it's the little things that make the biggest differences. Vanguard is one of those things, just not so little.

DHAI AKSHAR



Hritik Bhageria



We all have one goal that matters to us the most. It may differ from person to person, but most of us reading this will probably have the same goal - be happy, earn a good amount of money, have a happy family, and the list continues. Then, why is it that most of us fail to achieve our one true goal? What is the cause of this commonly occurring problem? Before looking for the solution, let's look within ourselves.

Most of us blame it on a lack of time, others or nature itself. Think again. Is that the actual reason? No. Then what is missing? In reality, all we are missing is dhai akshar. All we are missing is प्रेम. That is a word that is misunderstood by this generation. That is a word which holds a lot of meaning, but has just one motto.



प्रेम. It is neither present in the depths of hell nor the heights of heaven. Neither in the stars of the night sky nor the might of the sea. Then, where and how should we know or learn about it? That is what we miss in our day-to-day life. प्रेम is neither an emotion that you develop towards others nor a bond you have with your close ones.

प्रेम is the emotional aspect you always fail to see within yourself. Question yourself: when you love someone wholeheartedly, are you giving them more respect than your principles? If yes, you are making that person eligible to break them.

Your loved ones do not respect you because you hold them above your principles. They should love you because of your principles. We are always scared of losing something that we love, and due to that, we are forever engaged in doing things for that very something. We forget to ask ourselves this question: "Why should I be scared?" If you have your heart in it, then it won't leave you until you die. That is true love.

Let me explain this to you using a quote by our Pujya Gurudev Swami Chinmayanada: "Love is when I love without the I being there." Through these words, Gurudev was trying to explain to us that when we love, we love all that we care about selflessly. We do not focus on what we gain out of it. When we love without the I, then we see everything as equal. This

results in love for others as service. We serve society and give our best to benefit society.

It's our mind which makes us think that we can do anything to achieve something, but we don't understand that our relentless pursuits will only hurt us - and others - even more. We tend to ignore the people who actually care about us and leave them behind.

Has your mother or father ever asked you anything in return for their love towards you? Their love won't change, even in the worst situations or the most dire conditions. They will punish themselves for your failure to do the right thing, but praise you for your great deeds. It is they who will never leave you.

So, find these dhai akshars in your life, wherein you selflessly give to the world but never ask for anything in return. You will start to enjoy and love yourself for who you are, and the people around you will also be happy. This is what our school motto tries to tell us - ज्ञानं सेवा च कौशलम् | After receiving this knowledge, we are prepared to serve society. Through service, we progress, not only alone but also with the rest of society.

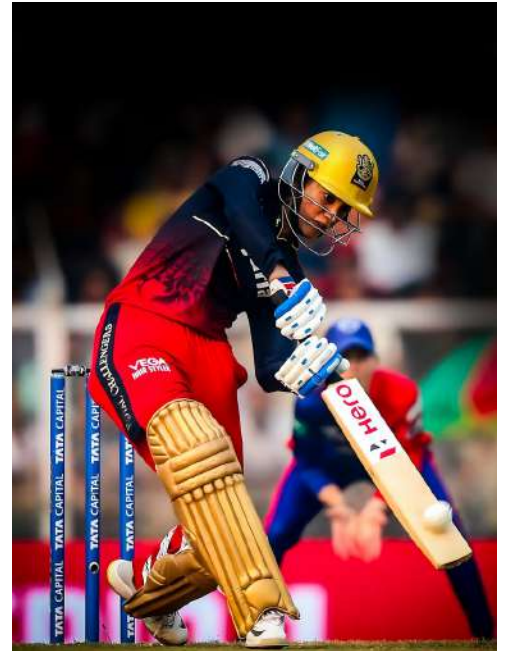
Warriors of the Pitch

“A woman definitely has just as much potential as a man, and it is time we forget such differences and focus on individual talents and merits instead of gender.”



From the streets of India to the Narendra Modi Stadium, the word ‘cricket’ never fails to bring immense joy and excitement to us. I can proudly say that the one thing that the majority of us bond over is cricket. An IPL match can bring us all together like nothing else. From cheering till our voices are hoarse to sitting on the edge of our seats in anticipation, I can safely say that cricket has a beloved spot in all of our hearts. But is the IPL really the only premier league that thrills and enthalls us? We often seem to overlook the women's premier league, the WPL.

The first season was played in March 2023, after Sourav Ganguly (the then-president of the BCCI) announced his plans to establish a women's version of the IPL. This was the first major step taken towards popularizing women's cricket! This amazing initiative has given a lot of hope and happiness to sportswomen all over India. This has motivated and pushed multiple women towards fulfilling their immense potentials. It has encouraged them to pursue their dreams, and has simply given them a reason to break all stereotypes.



But, as the second season was played this year (2024), has it really gained the same popularity as the IPL? Is it the talk of the town? Has this season been as groundbreaking as we originally expected it to be?

I don't think so...

Now, why is it that the WPL has not gained as much momentum as we initially hoped for? Why is it still not recognized by many?

It most certainly is not because of the quality of players. The women recruited are definitely top notch. They are passionate and extremely determined to do what they love.



They are ever-ready to show the world who they truly are. Although there are only 5 WPL teams as of now, they are most certainly making their mark on the world of cricket. They are extremely talented and have been working relentlessly to be the best versions of themselves. The cricket industry may be brutal, but these women have what it takes. They emerge victorious against their battle with the world over and over again. It is proof that there is scope and hope for women's cricket to go big-time in the sports world, that there is depth and talent in all corners of the country.

The net run rate of the reigning champions of the WPL, the Delhi Capitals, is 1.198. The WPL might be fairly new, but it is up there in terms of skill. They are still underrated and often put aside by the general public. People feel that cricket is not for women, and fail to recognize the potential in front of them. Therefore, the WPL teams are underrated, and are not given the importance and fame they deserve.



While the viewership of the WPL has seen a steady increase this year, it is still nothing compared to the huge fanbase of the IPL. This is majorly due to common prejudices and misconceptions. People usually assume that WPL players lack skill, and feel that the match might not be as interesting as an IPL match. People feel that the WPL would not give them the same rush of adrenaline and thrill. They think that a WPL match would not be capable of keeping them on the edge of their seats.

WRONG!

A WPL match is just as amusing and interesting as an IPL match. It has just as much potential! We must not overlook talent just because of a few petty prejudices. A woman definitely has just as much potential as a man, and it is time we forget such differences and focus on individual talents and merits instead of gender. The WPL is new, but there is an immense amount of scope for them to shine.

There will be daily matches during prime time, and they will have regular coverage. There will be viral videos and constant content generation on social media. There will be quality competitive cricket involving the best in the world to reiterate that the women's game has firmly established itself in the minds and the market of the cricket world. The blood, sweat and tears of these determined women will not go in vain.

The stage is set, the spotlight is here, and the show is about to begin.

These women are ready to tread the rocky paths ahead, and shatter all misconceptions and stereotypes that have confined them to society's four walls for years.

I mean... they have to be good to make it so far. We have to give them the recognition they deserve. If we can bond over popcorn and an IPL match, I am sure we can relate over a hearty game of the WPL and chocolate just the same!



FUELING ACHIEVEMENT

Chetk



Mental health. A phrase which has taken over the pages of the internet and the minds of the people by storm in the past decade. It is a subject which concerns a wide range of ages. From the 10-year-old who feels that his parents don't love him (because he wasn't allowed to go to his friend's birthday party when he didn't finish his homework) to the 80-year-old grandfather who is living out his last days in regret (because he thinks that he could've handled his divorce which happened 30 years ago in a better way), these people are going through something which is apparently called "depression." Depression, nowadays, is a term loosely thrown around during conversations between teenagers. A term used to address anything going on in their lives which might be only trivially connected to depression.

For example, you might hear, "Bro, my mom took my phone. I don't know what to do anymore! I think I'm going into depression." Depression has become a trend amongst teenagers these days, who find it normal to use such a word without first knowing the exact meaning of it, leave alone actually feeling that way.

In fact, the kind of content we consume online has a huge influence on our mindset, which directly correlates to our mental health. Why, one might even say that some teenagers find it "cool" to be depressed.

They think that being sad all the time makes them look different or unique, but subconsciously it is because they feel like they don't get the attention they deserve. This is a terrible and costly plague which has affected the youth of the world. Such an unnatural process inside the minds of the young makers of the future has led to their weakening.

That is precisely the objective of this article: to inform its readers of 21st-century influences on young minds, and how these influences can affect their mental strength.

A major factor in determining mental health is mental strength. Some use these terms interchangeably, but they mean different things. So before we get to mental health, we should talk about mental strength. Almost every parent in this world tells their children to stop indulging in the vibrant screens of their phones and laptops. Now, with the rage of YouTube Shorts and Instagram Reels engulfing the minds of the youth, the attractive 'infinity scrolling' makes the user want to glare at their screen for hours on end.

The brains of users are rotting, and more importantly, their minds have lost a vital component: focus. The children of today have lost the ability to sit in one place and do an action with complete focus for an extended period of time. According to a survey (which has been ongoing for around 2 decades), the average attention span of a human being has decreased from 12 seconds to 8 seconds. Focus is an integral part of a student's cognitive palette, without which the very purpose of being a student becomes non-existent.



Focus is integral to the process of grasping knowledge and to the mind's capacity of retaining it. One of the greatest warriors to ever walk this planet - Arjuna - is the ideal embodiment of focus displayed by a student, and should be taken as a role model by all students reading this article. When asked by the legendary Guru Dronacharya what he saw on the tree, he replied, "Only the eye of the bird; nothing else." When asked to shoot it, the arrow went straight through the eye. Focus on the target and nothing else. This was Arjuna's single-pointed focus, and it was this focus that made him one of the greatest warriors to ever live. The strength of the mind can easily be measured through the focus which the mind exhibits.

Higher the focus, higher the traction in daily actions with mental strength. Mental strength also underlines one's mental ability to remain firm in a non-conductive situation. The stronger one's mind is, the more stable they are during crucial times when the world tests them.

This is also where the concept of mental health comes in. The state of our mental health is determined heavily by the interaction of our minds with outside circumstances. Therefore, if your mind has enough strength to be unfazed by non-conductive externalities, it will result in positive mental health. For a student, this is something which is of utmost importance in their quest for knowledge.

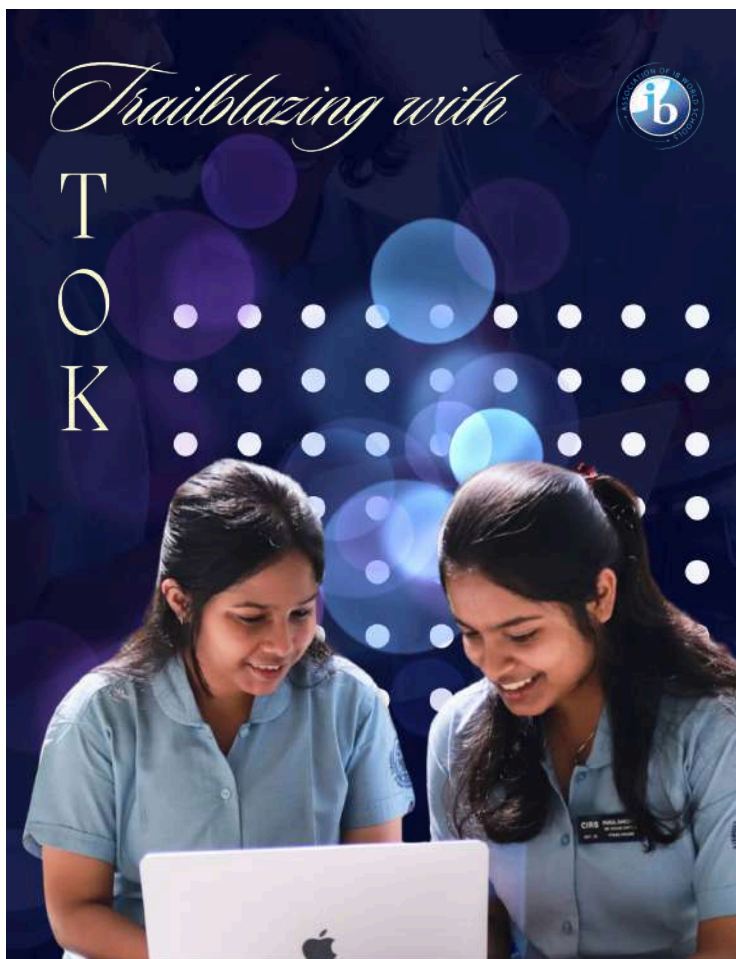


Fortunately for everyone reading this article, the ability of having single-pointed focus like Arjuna or having mental strength like that of Shri Ram doesn't always have to be a god-given gift. Our ancient seers and sages devised scientifically proven techniques and methods which can easily be followed by anyone. When followed consistently with genuineness, these will yield the above mentioned qualities and help a student reach their full potential. The methods and techniques include meditation, japa and sādhanā. These practices have been used by students in our country for several millennia and have produced geniuses of a different league altogether. However, it is slowly dying out.

Post-colonization and a lack of Indic education have induced a sense of ridicule towards these practices, especially within youngsters, whom these practices were meant for.

At CHYK, a huge emphasis is placed on the practice of sādhanā and meditation. These practices alone are to be credited for Chinmaya Yuvakendra members' immense mental strength and focus. Here at CIRS, these practices are encouraged to increase the efficiency and capabilities of us students, especially in our busy schedule. Hence, as students and conquistadors of knowledge, it is our responsibility to reinforce and strengthen our minds to improve our mental health, which will ultimately lead to better learning capabilities and becoming the best possible student. To conclude, this article humbly requests all its readers to take up these practices and spread them, so that a culture of learning and mental strength can be further established, encouraging youth to take up their roles as future change makers.





Exploring the Role of Emotions in Negotiations - A TOK Perspective

For example, empathy equips us to understand the opposite party's needs and perspectives, allowing us to build a collaborative working environment. Furthermore, emotions in negotiations extend beyond the individual negotiator, with cultural practices, social customs and personal biases also playing a significant role.

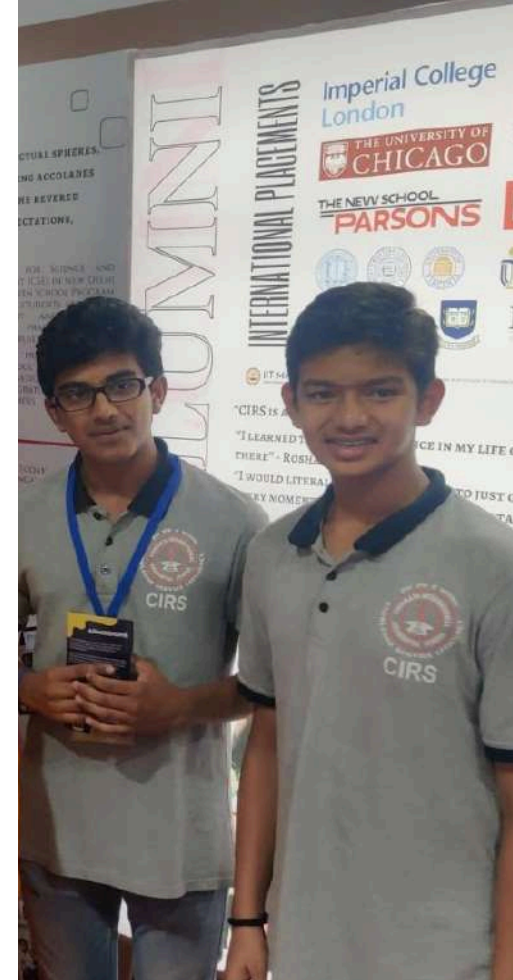
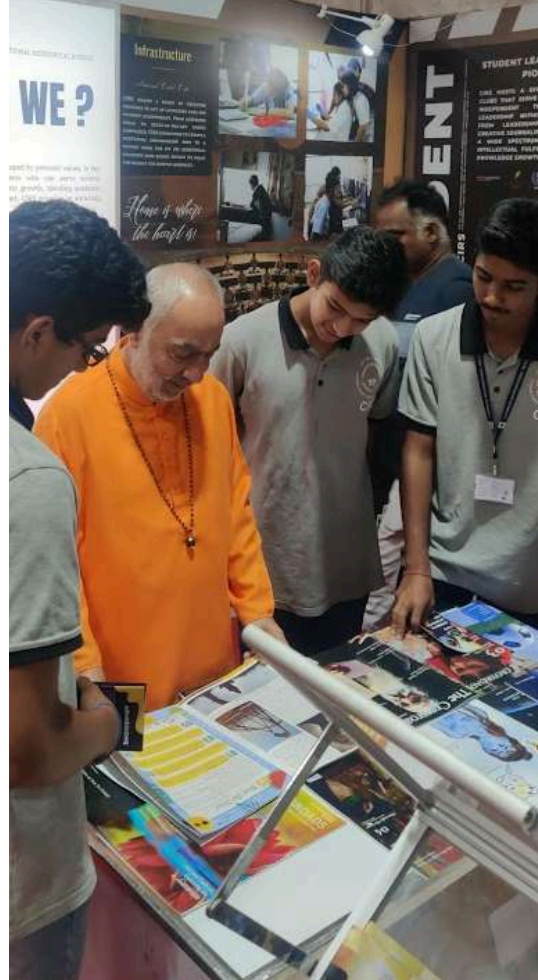
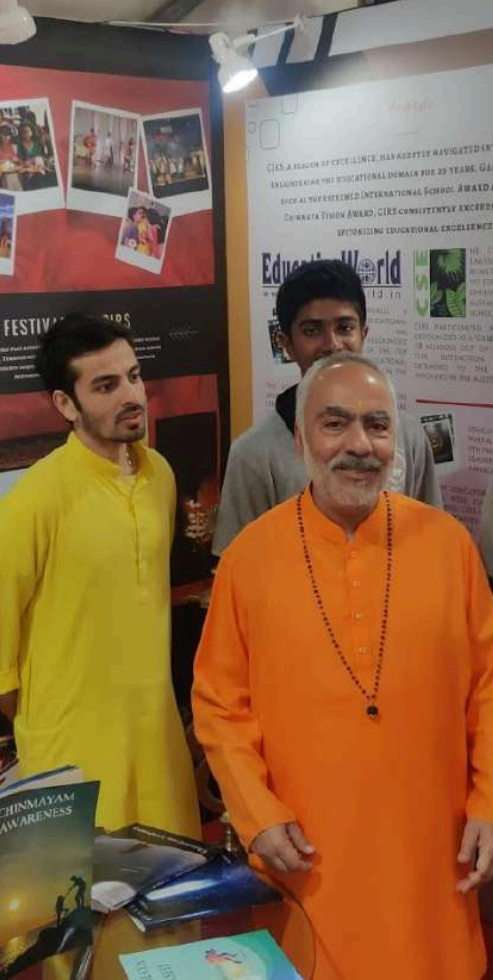
A core concept in TOK is skepticism, where we constantly question the information we base our decisions upon. In negotiation, this not only entails examining the knowledge we have, but also the emotions influencing our interpretations. By acknowledging the role of emotions and applying a healthy dose of skepticism, we can drastically increase our chances of success during negotiations.

TOK also encourages us to consider the ethical implications of our knowledge claims, as emotions are powerful tools that can be used to manipulate those involved in the debate. A negotiator might feign anger for concessions, or project sadness to gain empathy. While such tactics may achieve short term gains, they ultimately lead to a loss of trust and a collapse of relationships. Hence, we must ensure that we follow ethical negotiation practices, responsibly utilizing emotions to achieve mutually beneficial outcomes.

Emotions are an important part of negotiations, shaping people's understandings and interactions with each other. From a TOK perspective, emotions highlight the importance of skepticism, ethics and cultural awareness. By recognizing and managing emotions effectively, negotiations can help us achieve our goals and build trust.

That's why instead of denying the critical role emotions play in negotiations, good negotiators are able to precisely label the emotions they experience, and utilize them to their benefit.

Krrish Haran | IB I Year, CIRS



EXPERIENCES AT CHINMAYA SANKARAM

At the birthplace of Bhagwan Adi Shankaracharya and Gurudev Swami Chinmayananda, beneath the canopy of the coconut trees of Kerala, a national conference was held for four days. Starting on Gurudev's 108th Jayanthi, May 8, and ending on

Sankara Jayanthi, May 12, this conference was a truly enlightening experience with various talks and presentations. From our school we had Harshidh Baabu, Aryan I. G. and I (Rohith C. B.) volunteering to represent CIRS in the stall. With us, we had Shri. Arun, Sri Siva, Sri Annush, Br. Sanatanji, Brni. Bhaktiji, Kum. Dhivya, Smt. Meera and Smt. Lakshmi Mohan escorting us for the entire trip. We reached by the time it was afternoon on May 8th and went directly to our rooms to relax for a while. We started our work at the stall by around 4:30 pm and then we attended Swami Swaroopanandaji's thought-provoking talk on Dharma. The traveling had taken a serious toll on us, as we were asleep within moments after we entered our rooms. On the second day, Sanatanji, Bhaktiji and Harshidh Baabu joined us for the trip.

The stalls thrived on the second and third day, and after having attended to hundreds of visitors, even walking back to our residence seemed tiresome. Shri Dattatreya Hosabale, Secretary General of Rashtriya Swayamsevak Sangh addressed us about the impact the Chinmaya Mission has had on India and its youth.

There was something special about how he spoke; the way his personal experience transformed into knowledge for us young minds was truly seamless.

Then the ever-powerful J. Sai Deepak gave a talk; his passion for this nation spoke out loud enough to recharge all of us with higher and more deeply rooted nationalist sentiments.

We learnt a lot about the contributions that Gurudev and Adi Shankaracharyaji had made in the realm of philosophy. Our learning did not stop with the talks; we interacted with various members of the Chinmaya Mission and also went through books. All of the talks and the experience in the stall was on one side, while the most cherishing experience was to interact with our past mentors, Kum. Narayan and Gayatri Didi. We often got really weary, yet our enthusiasm never stopped us from interacting with more people and learning more. On the last day of the trip we visited the Adi Shankara Nilayam, Adi Shankaracharyaji's house, and had our breakfast there.

Towards the end, we visited the Chinmaya Vishwavidyapeeth (CVV) campus to attend the inauguration of the Annakshetra. Over there, Kum. Narayan took us on a trip around the campus and then we had our lunch in the newly inaugurated Annakshetra. At around 2:30 pm we left the campus and started our journey back to CIRS. In all, it was a fun-filled camp centered around pure knowledge, which has given me a lot of memories to cherish.

Aryan IG, Harshidh Baabu and Rohith Bellam | Grade 10 & 11

07



Crises and Catalysts

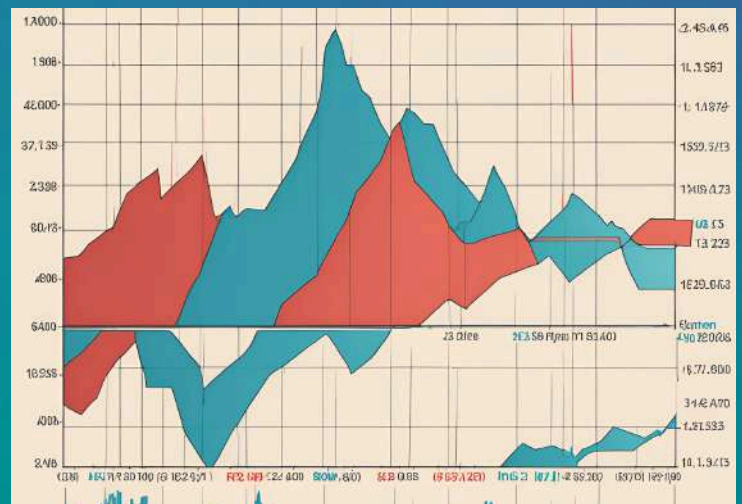
Political Elections and India's Stock Market Dynamics

Arnav Agrawal | Grade 11 MGMT, CIRS

The connection between political events and the stock market has always been complex and important. The stock market, unpredictable at best, often reacts strongly to political developments. The relationship between elections and the stock market has been an important subject for investors, analysts, and policy makers. The uncertainty and policy shifts linked to elections can significantly influence market inclination, leading to higher volatility and shifts in stock prices.

India's stock market has long been sensitive to the country's electoral outcomes, and the recent 2024 general elections were no exception. When exit polls predicted a sweeping victory for Prime Minister Narendra Modi's Bharatiya Janata Party (BJP)-led National Democratic Alliance (NDA), the benchmark indexes Nifty 50 and Sensex surged to record highs. Investors had grown used to the Modi government's pro-business policies during its previous terms, fueling hopes that PM Modi would continue his agenda of economic reform, infrastructural investment, and efforts to attract foreign capital.

However, the actual election results told a different story. The NDA fell short of a majority, forcing it to rely on smaller regional parties to form the government. This unexpected outcome sent shockwaves through the markets, with the Nifty 50 and Sensex plunging by over 5%. These inconsistencies and changes in investor behavior happened due to uncertainty surrounding election outcomes, political parties having differing policies, foreign investor sentiments, and overconfidence by the investors on the NDA's win.



This unstable market reaction to India's election result emphasizes the significant role that political unpredictability can play in shaping investor sentiment and stock market performance. For investors, this event serves as a reminder of the importance of diversification and a focus on fundamental business strengths, rather than relying heavily on pre-election predictions or political reports. In the aftermath of this election, investors will need to closely monitor the new government's agenda and its impact on various sectors. While the short-term volatility may persist, those who can look beyond the political noise and focus on the fundamental strengths of the Indian economy are likely to be better positioned to navigate the turbulence and capitalize on the country's long-term growth potential.

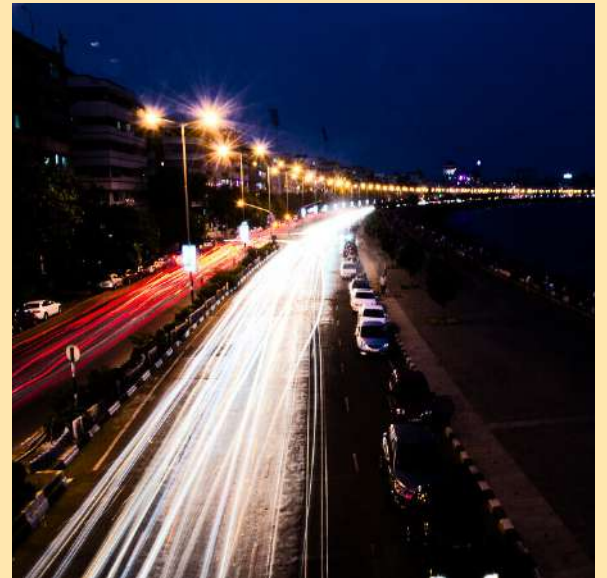
I am a true Mumbaikar

“मी खरी मुंबईकर आहे”

Ananya Sirohia | Grade 11 SCI, CIRS

Life in Mumbai can be hectic. The bustling crowd and the stress of living in a metropolitan city might take a toll on mental health, but it does not always have a negative impact. Three years in Mumbai have taught me a lot and shaped me into who I am today - a confident and passionate girl ready to face the world.

Stereotypes portray Mumbai as loud, tiring, and extremely expensive. Well, they are right about one thing-the expense. Other than the high cost of living, Mumbai is a phenomenal experience. Living in this city can only be described as one thing- ecstatic. Everywhere you go, you're always seeing things that excite you or inspire you to do something great. Like the roadside vendor selling vegetables saying "कांदा लेलो!" at the Gateway of India, every aspect of Mumbai has something magical to it, almost like Tinker Bell is around sprinkling pixie dust. From the vada pav that you get for 20 rupees to the gourmet food in fancy restaurants that cost a kidney, everything has a unique feeling to it.



Over the years, I have witnessed several developments in Mumbai - one being the Atal Setu, which leaves every visitor in awe of its glory. My favorite part of Mumbai though, is its people. The mixed population of Mumbai allows all types of people to find their comfort zone - the people who make them feel special and loved; maybe it's not meant for everyone, but it is definitely a once-in-a-lifetime experience. When I first moved to Mumbai, I was very reluctant to do so. I had lived in Kolkata for most of my life and was suddenly pulled away from the place where my entire childhood had been built. Imagine trying to leave such a place and never having the chance to go back. Looking back, I wish I could've told my younger self to stop whining as much as I had then and realize what a golden opportunity I was being given. It was truly a blessing in disguise.



When I say Mumbai welcomed me with open arms, I literally mean it. The friends I made and the experiences I had, like crossing the traffic of Mumbai and safely reaching the other side, or traveling in the metro alone at night, made me resilient and exposed to pretty much everything. If someone asked me, "What is the best place you know?" I would say without hesitation, "Mumbai!" One aspect of Mumbai that has built up the competitive side in me, is street shopping in Causeway or Hill Road. Only Mumbaikars know the amount of bargaining I have done on those streets; the feeling that the balance in my parents' bank account depended on those few rupees.

These gullies of Mumbai hold many undiscovered experiences and my favorite by far are the stray cats from whom I've learned to show so much affection and empathy. Things like the flamingos in Flamingo Park have shown me that even a city driven by money and power has things that have a much greater significance than just monetary value. It shows that even in such a bustling city, there are aspects that give it a certain serenity - almost like the calm lapping of ocean waves - expressing how insignificant actions can positively impact you in the most mind-boggling ways. Along with watching the setting sun slowly sink beneath the waves from Juhu beach, cycling in the morning on the highways of Mumbai makes one realize that happiness lies right there; there's no other place I would rather be in.



CIRS MATH EXPO 2024

Without mathematics, there's nothing you can do. Everything around you is mathematics. Everything around you is numbers.

– Shakuntala Devi

Recent reports suggest a sudden decline in cases of numerophobia (the fear of math) at CIRS. While others ponder upon this, let us celebrate the success of the CIRS Math Expo 2024.

On 27th June, the entire MPH felt ethereal, as if knowledge had infected the air in such a way that even the biggest math-haters found themselves drawn by the creativity our students had displayed. It seemed apt to see the future of math be nourished in the hands of young students. This exciting event wasn't just about numbers and equations; it was a celebration of creativity, exploration, and the inherent beauty of mathematics.

The Expo brought to life various concepts which the students were previously not even aware of. A total of 143 unique exhibits, each meticulously crafted by students and teachers, adorned the halls. The exhibits surpassed the traditional rote and complex nature of mathematics, providing insights into aspects of mathematics that textbooks often fail to bring out. Our education system seldom entertains the practical, real-life applications of mathematics, and the Expo perfectly curated a wide range of math concepts and presented them to audiences of varied ages. This event brought together a total of 793 students and 75 teachers from 23 schools across Coimbatore, Tirupur, Erode, and Pollachi.

“The goal of the Expo wasn’t just to showcase facts and figures,” explained Smt. Bhuvaneshwari, HOD of Mathematics. “We wanted to create an environment where students could explore the fascinating world of math in a fun and engaging way. We believe that by sparking curiosity and demonstrating the practical applications of math, we can help students overcome any fear they might have and develop a genuine love for the subject.”

This statement wasn’t made just for the sake of it. Weeks of research, days of planning and hours of work went into this Expo. The entire student body had been working on their projects since April, and this diligent approach is the reason the students remained engrossed in their projects despite the heavy workload.

“Even after sacrificing hours of sleep to work on the Math Expo, never once did I lose any interest.” says Keshav Bangur of IB 1st year.

The Expo was filled with workshops that were truly inspiring, and a few models stood out significantly. The ‘Zoetrope’, as its creators explained, was a revolving device, a precursor to modern animation. As the device spun, sequential images appeared to merge, creating the illusion of animated movement. This exhibit not only showcased a fun math concept but also provided a glimpse into the history of animation technology, demonstrating how mathematical concepts can be displayed using visual wonders.

The students of 11th Management put up a 3D model of the Sierpinski Triangle, a self-similar geometric pattern that repeats infinitely, growing smaller with every repetition. This model, apart from drawing tremendous attention from the audience, showed the elegance of fractal geometry while highlighting the connection between mathematics and intricate patterns in nature.

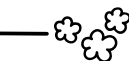
Celebrating India’s rich heritage of mathematics, students had the opportunity to learn about and present knowledge on fascinating concepts like the Hindu-Arabic numerals - the number system we use today - and the ingenious use of fractals in the construction of the famous Konark Sun Temple. By emphasizing on such historical contributions, the Expo instilled a sense of pride in students, shining light on the long-standing relationship between Bharat and the world of math.

While exposing students to plenty of knowledge on mathematics, the Expo also served a much greater underlying purpose: to get rid of the common “math-phobia” among students. The Expo had an interactive approach in its exhibits in the form of games and activities, which helped break barriers and let the students establish a more positive association with math. The entire school poured their heart and soul into this Math Expo, and the Expo’s success stands testament to the collaborative efforts of students, teachers and the entire CIRS community.



SPOTLIGHT

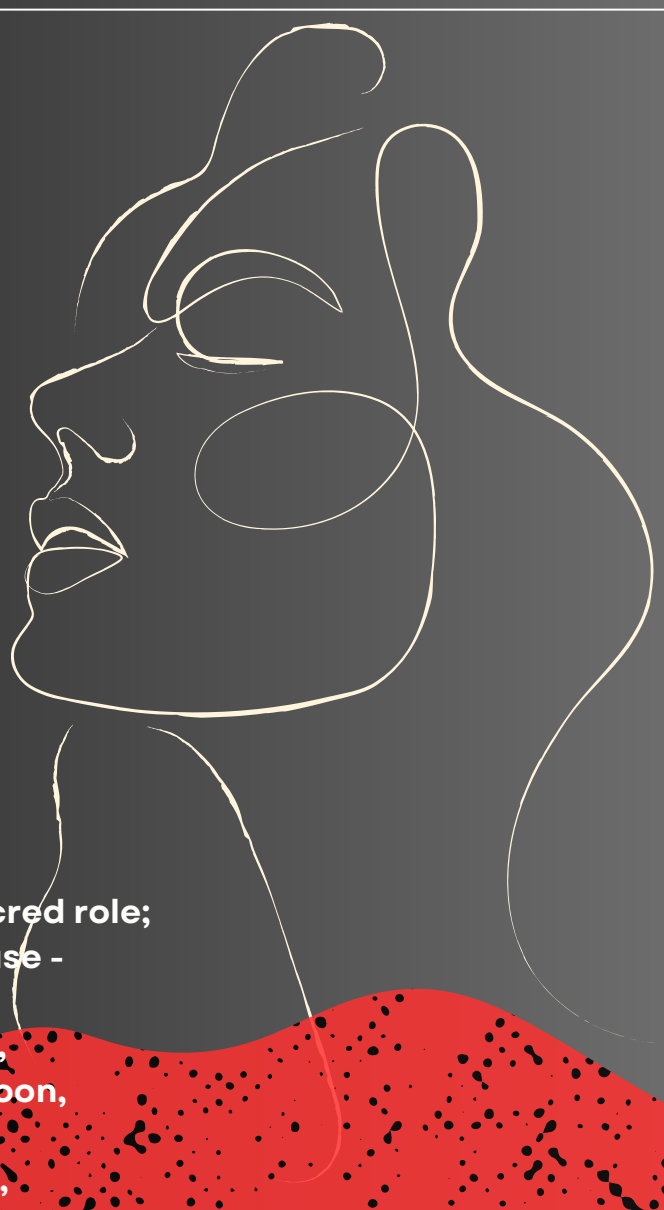
SHASHWATH SANTOSH | CIRS, BATCH OF 2019



Hari Om Bhaiya! Your time at school must have been very different from most others. Judging from students' sentiments, I can safely say that a complaining attitude was more prevalent at the time. What do you think was the factor that caused the mentality shift, and why?

This is something I realized years later, even though the mind shift happened at school. I realized that if you complain in one place, you will complain in every place. That was a powerful feeling that uplifted me. Even at work, I see overachieving CEOs who literally mint money while they sleep, but are not at all content with what they have. I sometimes have to go to California for work and the people there always tell me, “If you make 500K a month, you are still lower-middle class.” Talking to those top executives also made me realize that poverty is not a physical state but a mental one. If you complain in school, you will complain in college, and if you complain in college, you will definitely complain even when you have reached an amazing milestone in your life. In school, especially our school, you can either fall into your desires and get kicked out or you can stay out of your comfort zone and grow consistently. If you grow to like this place which has minimal comfort, you will learn to be content. Learning that life lesson is imperative to attaining happiness, happiness that material wealth just cannot afford.

HER



Her bright eyes sparkle
Like the midnight moon.
Brimming with surprises,
Guarding terrible secrets,
Holding little innocent white lies
And vaults of ravaging regrets.
A few have gone too far, too soon,
Seeking to unearth all she hides.
But unveiling them is a task taken on too soon
For they're guarded by her very soul.
It is her inescapable duty to protect them - her sacred role;
The power they hold, the destruction they can cause -
They can shatter the world, poke at its flaws.
So they're also pools of darkness, absorbing all joy,
Like the burning sun adding on to an unbearable noon,
Like the biting wind on freezing autumn days,
Like destroying sweet grass on fresh spring morns,
Like venomous clouds covering the last sun rays.
But there's also beauty in their malice,
And such beauty deserves palatial praise
For isn't the "devilish" darkness as stunning
As the teasing music of a mysterious night?
Like gazing at jagged peaks from afar;
Like the deadly gray between black and white.
Aren't storm clouds wonderful too in the way they move?
Their destruction a dance, their thunder a groove;
What a concoction of worlds she holds in her eyes!
Full of broken dreams and neglected cries
But holding more sympathy than you and I...
For the empathy such pain conceives can cover the infinite sky.
Look at how she feels, look into her eyes-
Oh! A universe you'll discover in the beauty she denies.
Look at how her eyes convey more than my words...
Perhaps it is better for me to keep quiet.
Let her eyes tell the tale of the world;
Let its mysteries be solved by her sight.

Avika Mundra | Grade 10, CIRS



KRISHNA

Rājya



This world is full of conflicting perspectives and ideologies, where selfish desires are placed at the highest pedestal and selfless service is demeaned. A place where most of the leaders enjoy a luxurious life but let their people starve to death. In this unjust, dark and gloomy world where people live under the blanket of corruption and refuse to wake up to the ever-effluent rays of dharma, Prafull Goradia and Jagannivas Iyer's '**Krishna Rājya**', a timeless literary masterpiece, acts as a walking stick for all blind leaders.



Inclining our turbulent minds towards the long-forgotten Dharma Rājya and removing the stains of malfeasance left behind by the unethical leaders of the past is the main objective of this political piece. A state where everyone serves each other with humility and respect. A state where every action taken by the state is to uphold dharma and guided by dharma. A state where the dazzling rays of dharma illuminate the lives of each citizen. Such an exuberant and dynamic state is none other than Kṛṣṇa's Dharma Rājya. This book does not just take you through Kṛṣṇa's kingdom but also gives you a taste of how other leaders have led their kingdoms.

By comparing the leadership ideologies of Otto von Bismarck, Sardar Vallabhbhai Patel and Abraham Lincoln, the authors explain how their sense of righteousness differed and how it impacted society. After bringing to light the merits and demerits of their leadership, the book gives you a sneak-peek of how Sri Rāma led his kingdom. Having looked at chefs all over the world who have cooked and decorated their dishes, we come to the master chef: Kṛṣṇa, and his delicacy - the Dharma Rājya. The perfect blend of discipline, merit and sacrifice, topped off with Kṛṣṇa's intellectual prowess, creates an everlasting fragrance of Dharma that resonates across the state.

Even for Kṛṣṇa, many challenges arose in his quest to re-establish dharma in Bhārat. He first planned to overthrow corruption and malfeasance in his birthplace. After enjoying much of his childhood, he came back to Mathura and ended Kāṁsa's ruthless reign. Soon after that, he reinstated Ugrasena as the king of Mathura and got the situation under control, but then Kṛṣṇa recalled Jarāsandha, the ruthless monarch whose eyes lurked over Mathura. Jarāsandha wanted to expand his tyrannical rule all over the world and prove to everyone that he was the greatest of all. At that point in time, he was also one of the most feared rulers of all, having conquered an enormous kingdom. On the other hand, Mathura was not very resourceful, and Kṛṣṇa's army was nothing in comparison to Jarāsandha's battalion.

Despite such a massive difference in strength and resources, Kṛṣṇa strategically defended Mathura from Jarāsandha's attacks 17 times. Every time there was a war, both kingdoms suffered significant losses, but Mathura was not able to recover from their losses and kept worsening. As time passed by, there were also foreign threats from Greek rulers whose intentions were similar to Jarāsandha's. He shifted his kingdom from Mathura to Dvārakā to save his people, and then killed the Greek ruler. Eventually, Kṛṣṇa went on to defeat Jarāsandha as well, and cleared his path to establish Dharma.



When he met the Pāṇḍavas, he felt that the Pāṇḍavas would be perfect to accompany him on this path of Dharma. As Kṛṣṇa explained his plans to them, the Pāṇḍavas became very fond of Kṛṣṇa and grew closer to him. The Pāṇḍavas accepted Kṛṣṇa as their charioteer who would keep them on the right path. Kṛṣṇa saw in Yudhiṣṭhira the perfect leader of the Dharma Rājya. Kṛṣṇa and the Pāṇḍavas embarked on a journey to re-establish Dharma all over the country. There were many challenges throughout the journey; there were also times when the Pāṇḍavas fell for emotional traps and faltered in their journey. But Kṛṣṇa stood strong for Dharma and made sure that the Pāṇḍavas never gave up on the path of righteousness. He made sure that Dharma Rājya became a reality, instead of remaining a utopian ideology. He ensured that Yudhiṣṭhira ruled the Dharma Rājya for years, instilling tranquility and righteousness in citizens' livelihood. This political renaissance of a book stands as a testament against all those who shun their duties and turn their back against Dharma. It serves as a necessary warning for all wrongdoers - **sooner or later, only Dharma shall prevail.**



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INTRODUCING ACROPOLIS

CIRS BAND 2024-25



BEYOND
THE
GAME

Krish Modi
Senior Sports Secretary
2023 - 2024

Although the new academic year has just begun with great enthusiasm and zeal, plenty of great mental effort for the CIRSMUN and Math Expo has been put up by the portion of the student body involved in these events. Alongside this, sports in CIRS have also witnessed a fantabulous head-start since April.

The year began with our talented table tennis players who went to represent our school in the Rising Star Inter-Club Open Doubles competition in April. In this competition, Shaurya Gadhyar and Lakshya Sagar of Class 10 emerged as the Runners-Up in their category & Yashwarrrdhan Kejriwal of 1st Year IB and Nidharshan of Class 7 bagged 3rd place in their category.

Some of our P.E. Department teachers also attended the Yoga Training Session on the eve of the International Yoga Day Celebrations on the 29th of June. The event was conducted by the Sahodaya Sports Complex. The main highlight of the event was that it was conducted entirely by Br. Vignesh Chaitanyaji of Chinmaya Mission Coimbatore, who was also the Chief Guest of the event. The saddening part, however, was that most of our students could not participate in any of these competitions, since they only come knocking during the months of October and November. Despite the shortcomings, there were some students who grabbed the opportunity to represent their house in various Inter-House competitions and brought laurels to their house by contributing points to it.

The commendable spirit and unity of the Vasishtha House has led to remarkable results in their sports standings, as they are back standing 1st in the race after two long years with 410 points.

Their major contributions came from the Inter-House Basketball competition, where they bagged the 1st position in Senior Boys and Super-Senior Girls Category, and the Junior Football results, where the Sub-Juniors and Junior Boys' teams contributed a whopping 40 points by emerging as the winners in their categories.

They also earned a significant number of points from the Inter-House Badminton and Table Tennis competitions. Following the champions stands the sleek difference of 5 points between Valmiki and Vyasa House, with Valmiki standing 2nd with 345 points and Vyasa standing 3rd with 340 points. Both the houses will battle it out right till the very end of this Khel Mela, making every event count and every participant carry the burden of the house towards victory.

In surprising fashion, our previous year's champions - the Vishwamitra house - stand 4th in the table with 305 points. The house faced a great loss in the Inter-House Table Tennis and Badminton competitions. There still seems to be a ray of hope for the house owing to its strong comeback in the Inter-House Basketball tournament and, if the trend continues, the house might as well come back to where it was at the end of the previous year. This undaunted spirit of sportsmanship and camaraderie has indeed instilled a great sense of responsibility into us in terms of excelling in sports by contributing in every way possible, whether it be the house or the school. All students should understand that every point they contribute towards their house matters and every inter-school competition they go to becomes their contribution towards that sport, a mark of their discipline and respect towards it.

Captures







CREATIVE CORNER



Pranav P. ~ XII 📷



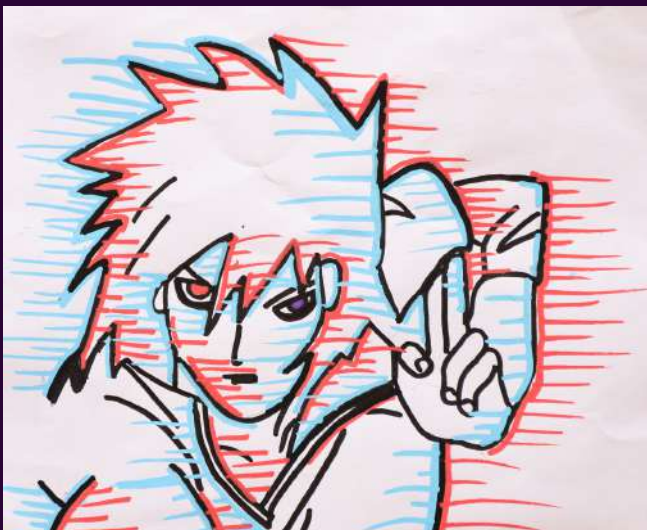
Abarna R. ~ XI 📷



Aryavardhan A. ~ VII 📷



Vedant A. ~ VI 📷



Vishnu J. ~ VII 📷



Kartik J. ~ VII 📷



K. Hitesh ~ VII 📷



Radha G. ~ X 



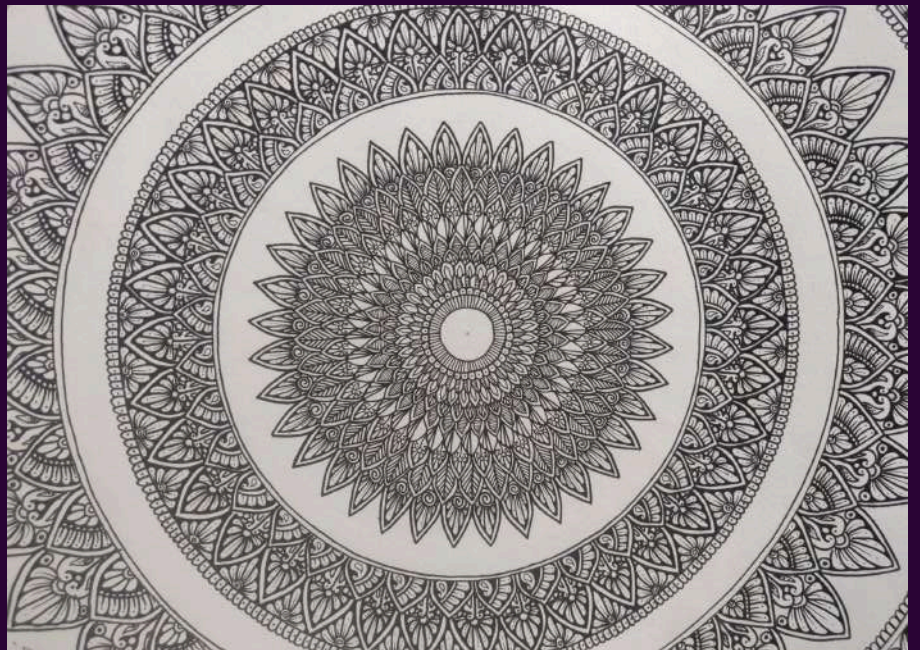
Aashi K. ~ IX 



Sia R. ~ XI 



Lokk V. ~ X 



Dhriti S. ~ IB I 



Vaidehi M. ~ IB I 



Pirai S. ~ VII 

Intelligent man alone is given the freedom to rebuild his future. A true seeker is one who is constantly asserting - day by day, hour by hour - this privilege.

July 2024 | Living the Vision of the Visionary



Chinmaya International Residential School

Dear Soham Bhaiya,

Watching you and the Men in Blue lift the T20 World Cup, we felt like a primordial spark had ignited within us - the drive to lift our own trophies and make Bharat proud! You have been an unimaginably strong source of inspiration for all of us. We are truly, truly indebted to you - for your talent, for your achievement, and... for you!

Yours Truly
Crossroads Editorial Team '24 & '25



Connect with us
www.cirschool.org
gosthree



Had dreamt of it 17 years ago - watching the guys lift the cup for India at The Wanderers in Sept 2007.

The dream was scary. Far fetched. A long shot. Beyond reality. I had to reevaluate the path. Accept. Adjust.

Finally, today, look where life has brought me.

Dream big. Follow your heart. Take risks. Surrender. Have faith. Above all - be brutally honest with yourself!

